

IITs AND IIMs

Empires of the MIND

By providing a highly trained workforce for the world, institutions like IITs and IIMs have become global brands, more than just factories of five-point someones



INVENTORS AND THEIR INVENTIONS: Students at work at IIT, Kharagpur

■ By Shruti Maheshwari

In the late '70s when Krithi Ramamritham, present dean-R&D at the Indian Institute of Technology, Bombay, was a B.Tech graduating from IIT, Madras, the done thing was to go abroad for further studies. "If you didn't, it was assumed that you've missed the boat," he says. Staying back for a Ph.D was hardly an issue to deliberate. The placements scenario was far from compelling. Graduates would jostle for the attention of 20-odd companies, but the best they could hope for was an

annual salary of Rs 25,000. Today, it takes little to keep them from going West. The initial placement offerings go up to Rs 6 lakh a year and the job profiles have changed dramatically. A. Subash Babu, professor at IIT, Bombay, explains that students these days get offers for high-end jobs in sectors like consulting, engineering, software development, investment banking, analytics and R&D. "These jobs require great intellectual capacity as opposed to just logging abilities," he adds.